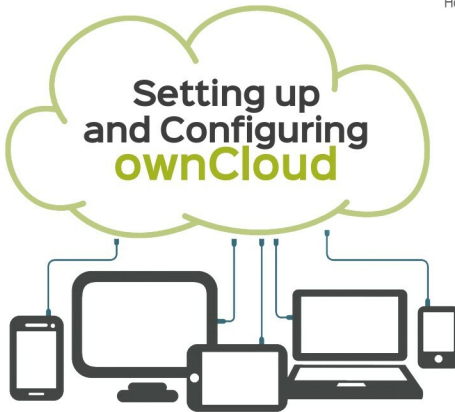




This article introduces the reader to ownCloud, which is a free and open source private cloud platform to help you access, sync and share data.

Ever thought about having your own cloud? Well, now you can, thanks to ownCloud, which is an open source, self-hosted app platform that enables you to share and sync your files across multiple devices and with many people. With dozens of apps available, it gives you access to a rich set of functions.

What is ownCloud?

ownCloud is an open source 'file sync and share' software for everyone—from individuals using the free ownCloud Server edition, to large enterprises and service providers subscribing to the ownCloud Enterprise edition. You can share one or more files and folders on your computer, and synchronise them with your ownCloud server. If you place files in your local shared directories, they get immediately synchronised to the server and to other devices using the ownCloud Desktop Sync client, the Android app, or the iOS app.

What makes ownCloud different?

The one thing that sets ownCloud apart is that it's open source and freely available to anyone who wants to set up ownCloud on a local server. The open source nature of ownCloud means that there is a community ready to help with any issue that you might encounter. The app store is one of the most important aspects of ownCloud, with a wide variety of apps that let you personalise your cloud.

System requirements

- ownCloud can run with a minimum of 128MB of RAM, but 512MB is recommended.
- Ubuntu 14.04 LTS+ or Debian 7+
- MySQL/MariaDB
- PHP 5.4+
- Apache 2.4 with mod_php

Set-up and configuration

The ownCloud server package is not available within Ubuntu's default repositories. However, ownCloud maintains a dedicated repository for Ubuntu 16.04. A release key should be added to *apt* and the repo link should be specified in the *sources.list* file to install ownCloud and its dependencies.

To add the release key, download it using *wget* and import it using the *apt-key* command, as follows:

```
$ wget -nv https://download.owncloud.org/download/
repositories/9.1/Ubuntu_16.04/Release.key -O Release.key
$ sudo apt-key add - < Release.key
```

The 'Release.key' is an encrypted public key which *apt* will use to verify the authenticity of ownCloud packages. In addition to that, add the ownCloud repository in a file called *owncloud.list* and save it in the *sources.list.d*